

Expert Past Predictions Track Record — 9-Expert Panel

Unbiased Sampling of High-Stakes Geopolitical Predictions

Compiled March 1, 2026 | Scoring: TRUE ≥ 0.75 | PARTIAL 0.25–0.74 | FALSE < 0.25

1. Stefan Molyneux

Bio: YouTuber/commentator, libertarian-populist, no formal IR credentials **Mean Accuracy: 0.200** | 0 true, 2 partial, 4 false | Beta(1.70, 5.30) → E[p] = 0.24

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Trump would fundamentally restructure government (2016)	Partial — won election, institutional transformation limited	0.30
EU would disintegrate due to migration/Brexit (2016–19)	False — EU remained intact	0.10
Mass immigration → civilizational collapse in Europe (2015–20)	False — significant challenges but no collapse	0.10
South Africa rapid state failure / "white genocide" (2010s)	False — serious problems but not state failure	0.15
Crypto as revolutionary decentralization (2017–18)	Partial — survived but didn't replace fiat	0.40
COVID lockdowns would become permanent authoritarian control (2020–21)	False — most restrictions lifted within 1–2 years	0.15

2. John Mearsheimer

Bio: U. Chicago professor, leading structural realist, *Tragedy of Great Power Politics* **Mean Accuracy: 0.814** | 4 true, 3 partial, 0 false | Beta(6.20, 1.80) → E[p] = 0.78

Prediction	Outcome	Score
NATO expansion would provoke Russia (1990s–2014)	True — Georgia (2008), Crimea (2014), full invasion (2022)	1.00
Iraq War would be strategic disaster (2003)	True — prolonged quagmire, spawned ISIS	1.00
Israel lobby shapes US Middle East policy (2007)	Partial — influential thesis, debated but largely substantiated	0.70
Liberal hegemony would fail globally (2001–2020)	True — Afghanistan, Iraq, Libya all validate	0.90
China as peer competitor regardless of engagement (2000s)	True — rivalry escalated dramatically	0.90
Ukraine War: prolonged war, NATO expansion as root cause (2022)	Partial — war is prolonged (correct), causal attribution debated	0.70
Offshore balancing as US strategy (general)	Partial — US pivoted to Asia but kept ME involvement	0.50

3. Jeffrey Sachs

Bio: Columbia economist, UN advisor, development/diplomacy advocate **Mean Accuracy: 0.664** | 3 true, 4 partial, 0 false | Beta(5.15, 2.85) → E[p] = 0.64

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Russia shock therapy assessment (1990s retrospective)	Mixed — his role debated; transition was disastrous	0.30
Iraq War: massive humanitarian costs (2003)	True — costs far exceeded projections	0.90
NATO expansion contributed to Ukraine crisis (2022)	Partial — valid structural argument, doesn't excuse invasion	0.60
US sanctions on Iran counterproductive (2018+)	True — Iran accelerated nuclear program, didn't capitulate	0.85
COVID origins: pushed lab-leak theory (2020–23)	Partial — became mainstream possibility, some claims overreached	0.50
Multipolar world order emerging (2020s)	Partial — trend real but slower/messier than predicted	0.60
Libya intervention would create failed state (2011)	True — Libya collapsed into civil war	0.90

4. George Friedman

Bio: Stratfor founder, geopolitical forecaster, *The Next 100 Years* author **Mean Accuracy: 0.613** | 2 true, 6 partial, 0 false | Beta(5.40, 3.60) → E[p] = 0.60

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Russia would reassert itself in near-abroad (pre-2014)	True — Crimea, Donbas, full invasion	0.90
EU would face severe internal stress (2010s)	Partial — Brexit happened, EU strained but survived	0.60
Japan significant rearmament by 2020s	Partial — increased spending but slower than predicted	0.50
Turkey as rising dominant ME power (2010s)	Partial — more assertive but economic/political constraints	0.55
US shale revolution would reshape geopolitics (2010s)	True — shale boom transformed US energy posture	0.85
Poland as major European military power (2020s–30s)	Partial — investing heavily but still developing	0.50
China won't surpass US (long-term)	Partial — China faces headwinds but remains very powerful	0.60
Iraq as 'buying time' strategy (2003)	Mixed — strategic argument debatable	0.40

5. Scott Ritter

Bio: Former UNSCOM weapons inspector, Marine intelligence officer, Russia/Iraq commentator **Mean Accuracy: 0.338** | 2 true, 1 partial, 5 false | Beta(3.20, 5.80) → E[p] = 0.36

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Iraq had no significant WMDs (2002)	True — vindicated; no WMDs found	1.00
US couldn't take Baghdad, military defeat (2003)	False — US took Baghdad quickly	0.15
US would bomb Iran by June 2005 (wrote <i>Target Iran</i>)	False — no attack occurred for ~20 years	0.10
Syria al-Kibar had no nuclear program (2007)	False — IAEA confirmed undeclared reactor	0.10
Ukraine/Bucha: claimed Ukraine responsible (2022)	False — extensive evidence links killings to Russia	0.00
Russia would achieve swift victory in Ukraine (early 2022)	False — failed to take Kyiv, prolonged war	0.15
Russia will ultimately win Ukraine war (2022–present)	Partial — holds territory, no decisive victory; war ongoing	0.40
Iraq long-term instability post-2003	True — insurgency, civil war, ISIS	0.80

6. Alastair Crooke

Bio: Former MI6 officer, EU Middle East advisor, Conflicts Forum founder, 30+ years ME experience **Mean Accuracy: 0.714** | 4 true, 3 partial, 0 false | Beta(5.50, 2.50) → E[p] = 0.69

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Syria: arming rebels would empower jihadists (2012)	True — ISIS rose, rebel factions included extremists	0.90
Libya intervention → failed state (2011)	True — Libya collapsed into civil conflict	0.90
Afghan mujahideen: some groups posed severe long-term danger (1980s)	True — Taliban, al-Qaeda vindicated this	0.90
Iran's institutions would withstand sanctions/pressure (2019–26)	True — regime survived massive protests and sanctions	0.80
Assad would survive with Russian/Iranian backing (2012–23)	Partial — held for 12 years but fell Dec 2024	0.50
Hezbollah resilient and would endure (post-2006)	Partial — rebuilt post-2006 but severely degraded 2024	0.50
Saudi anti-Iran posture would escalate tensions (2017)	Partial — tensions rose, surprising normalization, then re-escalation	0.50

7. Narges Bajoghli

Bio: Johns Hopkins SAIS professor, political anthropologist, 10+ years ethnographic fieldwork in Iran **Mean Accuracy: 0.860** | 5 true, 0 partial, 0 false | Beta(4.80, 1.20) → E[p] = 0.80

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Iran 2022 "Woman Life Freedom" protests: regime would NOT collapse	True — regime survived, though brutally	0.90
Iran's revolutionary institutions deeply rooted, would withstand bombing	True — institutions persisted through sanctions, assassinations, protests	0.85
Sanctions would devastate civilians without changing regime behavior (2018+)	True — well-documented humanitarian impact, no capitulation	0.90
Iran learned from Iran-Iraq War to build perseverance institutions	True — defense posture reflects this doctrine	0.80
Regime media strategy failing with Iranian youth (2019)	True — youth dissatisfaction continued, protests grew	0.85

8. Ali Vaez

Bio: ICG Iran Project Director, helped broker JCPOA, PhD Geneva, Georgetown adjunct professor **Mean Accuracy: 0.880** | 5 true, 0 partial, 0 false | Beta(4.90, 1.10) → E[p] = 0.82

Prediction	Outcome	Score
JCPOA was achievable through bridging negotiations (2013–15)	True — deal signed 2015	0.90
US withdrawal would accelerate Iran's nuclear enrichment (2018)	True — Iran ramped to 60%+ enrichment	0.90
Protests alone insufficient for regime change (2019, 2022)	True — regime survived both waves	0.85
Maximum pressure wouldn't bring Iran to table on US terms (2019–20)	True — Iran didn't capitulate, no new deal	0.85
Iran nuclear breakout time was shrinking as deal collapsed (2020s)	True — dropped from ~1 year to weeks	0.90

9. Stephen Kinzer

Bio: Brown University senior fellow, former NYT bureau chief, author of *Overthrow* and *All the Shah's Men*
Mean Accuracy: 0.657 | 4 true, 3 partial, 0 false | Beta(5.10, 2.90) → E[p] = 0.64

Prediction	Outcome	Score
Iraq War would produce consequences worse than imagined (2003)	True — ISIS, regional destabilization, trillions spent	0.90
Iranians wouldn't rise up due to foreign military action (2005+)	True — consistent with all subsequent evidence	0.85
Libya intervention "always produces unforeseen consequences" (2011)	True — Libya became failed state	0.85
US regime change produces negative long-term effects (general thesis)	True — historically documented across 14 cases	0.80
Turkey-Iran as natural US partners (<i>Reset</i> thesis, 2010)	Partial — Turkey went authoritarian, Iran remained adversary	0.30
Syria rebels included dangerous elements (2016)	Partial — rebel extremism real, framing debated	0.55
Opposed US arms to Ukraine (2022)	Partial — war devastating, but arms helped Ukraine survive	0.35

Summary Ranking by Track Record

Rank	Expert	Mean Accuracy	E[p] (Beta)	Domain
1	Ali Vaez	0.880	0.82	Iran nuclear/diplomacy specialist
2	Narges Bajoghli	0.860	0.80	Iran society/institutions specialist
3	John Mearsheimer	0.814	0.78	Structural realism / great powers
4	Alastair Crooke	0.714	0.69	Middle East intelligence / resistance movements
5	Jeffrey Sachs	0.664	0.64	Development economics / intervention critique
6	Stephen Kinzer	0.657	0.64	Intervention history / regime change
7	George Friedman	0.613	0.60	Geopolitical forecasting / geography
8	Scott Ritter	0.338	0.36	Weapons inspection / military analysis

Rank	Expert	Mean Accuracy	E[p] (Beta)	Domain
9	Stefan Molyneux	0.200	0.24	Populist commentary (no IR credentials)

Note: Bajoghli and Vaez have fewer scored predictions (n=5 each) vs. others (n=6–8), which means their Beta posteriors are wider — the model accounts for this uncertainty. Their high scores reflect domain-specific accuracy on Iran, which is directly relevant to the current conflict.